HARAWAY’S KEY IDEAS

1 CYBORG

I feel it is necessary to give Haraway’s cyborg a lengthy treatment here; it has had a long and complex life, or series of lives, and the ‘cyberquake’ it generated rumbles on in endless aftershocks. So I shall start with the Cyborg Manifesto, *not* the birthplace of the cyborg, not its ‘origin story’ – these things being resolutely un-cyborgian – but as the place where the author began to think through a particular and located figuration, in a particular intellectual and political context, which needs to be mapped out with some precision if we are going to understand the significance (and also the limitations) of thinking with the cyborg. And like its sci-fi kin the replicants, in the movie *Blade Runner* (1982), the cyborg has been tasked with a lot of difficult and dirty work, so we also need to spend quite a bit of time exploring that here.

CYBORG MANIFESTO

> You can tell you are in the presence of a cyborg figure when you feel a new world coming into being around you.
>
> (Myerson 2000: 24)

In a critical overview of Haraway’s work, Rene Munnik (2001) describes the ‘short prehistory’ of the Cyborg Manifesto: in 1983 Haraway contributed two papers to a conference, ‘New Machines, New Bodies, New Communities: Political Dilemmas of a Cyborg Feminist’ and ‘The Scholar and the Feminist X:The Question of Technology’, and in the following year she published a version of the Manifesto in a German journal, though that essay focused more on genetic engineering. In 1985, following a request from the editors of the journal *Socialist Review* to submit a short commentary on the state of socialist feminism in the Reagan ‘Star Wars’ era, the article was published therein as ‘A Manifesto for Cyborgs: Science, Technology, and Socialist Feminism in the 1980s’ (Haraway 1985).

Haraway describes the commissioning of the Manifesto in an interview:

> Socialist feminism had disappeared as a living social movement in the United States. Although it hardly ever existed as a living social movement in the United States, or frankly

> too little, it had been a kind of compelling vision, a kind of consensual hallucination anyway … [*Socialist Review*] sent a bunch of us letters and said, 'Look, you were all socialist feminists. What happened? What does it mean in the Reagan years?' 'A Manifesto for Cyborgs' emerged as a kind of dream-space piece.
>
> (Gordon 1994: 243)

The essay was, she puts it, written 'to try to think through how to do critique, remember war and its offspring, keep ecofeminism and technoscience joined in the flesh, and generally honor possibilities that escape unkind origins' (Haraway 2004a: 3). The Manifesto was then revised and collected into *Simians, Cyborgs, and Women* along with nine other important essays on what she would later call 'naturecultures' (Haraway 1991), with the slight but important changes to its title,'A Cyborg Manifesto: Science, Technology, and Socialist-Feminism in the Late Twentieth Century'. It has been lively in print ever since, tinkered with by Haraway and by others, reappearing in Haraway's subsequent work, as well as starring in countless *Readers* and being cited and worked over in a dizzying range of contexts (as we shall see). One last fact about the Manifesto's birth that has become almost legendary: it was the first article that Haraway wrote on a computer, her first foray into cyborg writing (Kunzru 1998). As Sofoulis (2002) writes, the Manifesto was *zeitgeisty* for lots of reasons, not least that its publication occurred at precisely the time when lots of humanities academics were starting to experience computers in their working lives, were starting to feel a bit like cyborgs themselves.

STAR WARS

Known officially as the Strategic Defence Initiative (SDI), the 'Star Wars' programme was conceived in the early 1980s, during the Reagan administration, as a space-based defence 'shield' to protect the USA from nuclear missile attack. It centred on the development of a satellite-mounted x-ray laser curtain, and the programme was dubbed 'Star Wars' by critics who saw it as little more than science fiction. The programme was abandoned a decade after its inception.

Schneider (2005: 58) quite rightly calls the Manifesto 'challenging, difficult, and exhilirating', but I think he is wrong to call it 'somewhat dated'; perhaps we should say instead that, as Haraway herself has pointed out, it belongs to a particular time and place, as noted in the story of its sourcing: it is a Reagan-era product reflecting on post-Second World War America, on technoscience and politics, or perhaps on technoscience *as* politics and vice versa. John Christie (1992: 175) also writes that the Manifesto has 'a recognizably eighties feminist political and aesthetic sensibility', that it is a kind of time capsule or period piece, even as it has lived on, endlessly cited and quoted.True, it talks of Star Wars and Reaganism, and doesn't foresee the many technoscientific challenges and adventures ahead, but its resonant shockwaves justify its longevity as much more than a relic or curio (see also Crewe 1997). But, while the cyborg has been wrenched from its historical and geographical locations, pushed back to the future and forward to the past, it is important to see the situatedness of the cyborg, and of the Manifesto, before attending to its subsequent disembedding, stretching and morphing.

SOCIALIST FEMINISM

Also known as materialist feminism, this branch of feminist theory and politics has its roots in Marxism, and argues that liberation for women can be achieved only by working to end the causes of women's oppression, which are economic and cultural. Socialist feminism thus broadens strictly Marxist feminism's focus on the central role of capitalism in the oppression of women, adding in elements from radical feminism's theorizations of patriarchy, thereby highlighting the interrelations of class and gender.

TECHNOSCIENCE

A concept widely used in interdisciplinary science and technology studies to designate the social and technological context of science. It is used to acknowledge that science and technology are inseparable, and that both are also inseparably social. Haraway (1997: 50) calls it a 'condensed signifier which mimes the implosion of science and technology' and which as such 'designates dense nodes of human and non-human actors that are brought into alliance by the material, social, and semiotic technologies through which what will count as nature and as matters of fact will get consitituted'.

CYBORG STORYING

I want to begin by describing the Manifesto, its form and content, and then to move closer and explore its key ideas. It may be challenging and difficult, but it is definitely also exhilarating, and rewards repeat reading. The first time I attempted the Manifesto, it really made my head hurt; it still does, at times, but there's such a thrill to reading it, so many clever and funny moments, so much work. As I hold a densely annotated copy in my hand – one of several, all bearing the marks of past readings – I still keep seeing new things, new connections, new diffractions. A dreamspace piece indeed.The Manifesto comprises six interlocked sections, and I want to sketch these here.

AN IRONIC DREAM OF A COMMON LANGUAGE FOR WOMEN IN THE INTEGRATED CIRCUIT

This opening section introduces Haraway's way of thinking the cyborg and the Manifesto; the former is 'a creature of social reality as well as a creature of fiction', the latter 'an ironic political myth faithful to feminism, socialism, and materialism', to which she adds that it is 'faithful as blasphemy is faithful', starting the playful (yet deadly serious) unpicking and unpacking, redescribing and diffracting that characterizes the article (Haraway 1991: 149). Sofoulis (2002) notes that this is the most-quoted section of the Manifesto, full of telling phrases that we do indeed find littered across countless subsequent cyborg stories, though they are often pared down to aphorisms.These are among my favourites:

- By the late twentieth century, our time, a mythic time, we are all chimeras, theorized and fabricated hybrids of machine and organism; in short, we are all cyborgs. The cyborg is our ontology; it gives us our politics.
- This essay is an argument for *pleasure* in the confusion of boundaries and for *responsibility* in their construction.
- The cyborg is a creature in a post-gender worlds; it has no truck with bisexuality, pre-Oedipal symbiosis, unalienated labor, or other seductions to organic wholeness …
- The cyborg is resolutely committed to partiality, irony, intimacy, and perversity. It is oppositional, utopian, and completely without innocence.
- Cyborgs are not reverent; they do not remember the cosmos. They are wary of holism, but needy for connection …
- The main trouble with cyborgs … is that they are the illegitimate offspring of militarism, patriarchal capitalism, not to mention state socialism. But illegitimate offspring are often exceedingly unfaithful to their origins.Their fathers, after all, are inessential.

(Haraway 1991: 150 – 1)

These fragments, even decoupled from their overall flow, contain so many of the key themes of the Manifesto it isn't surprising they have been copied and used in many subsequent discussions: the refusal of transcendent wholeness, the illegitimacy, the anti-psychoanalytic view, the *irony*. … In fact, the irony of the Manifesto has been quite a source of trouble in its afterlife, being either used to dismiss the article as pointless postmodern relativism or being missed in readings that take things too literally; as Haraway says in an interview, the Manifesto was written with a 'kind of contained ironic fury', but 'the reading practices … took me aback from the very beginning, and I learned that irony is a dangerous rhetorical strategy' (Markussen, Olesen and Lykke 2003: 50). So, the irony is also fury, irony used as a way to contain fury, to make it more productive. These are not the 'ramblings of a blissed-out, technobunny, fembot' (Haraway 2004a: 3); the commitment to socialist feminism, but also the critique of it (and of other feminisms), for one thing, often get stepped over by readings that wrench a few key phrases out of the article and spin their own theories from there. As I have done above; let me rectify that now.

CLYNES' AND KLINE'S CYBORG

Two scientists, Manfred Clynes and Nathan Kline, are credited with creating the first cyborg, or cybernetic organism, as part of their research at Rockland State Hospital, New York, into adapting the human body for space travel. As part of this work they fitted a 220g white laboratory rat with a 'Rose' osmotic pump, designed to automatically inject chemicals into the rat to control aspects of its biochemistry. In their famous 1960 paper for *Astronautics*, they not only published the nowfamous photo of this cyborg, but also discussed the many modifications to human bodies necessary for a future life in space, drawing heavily on cybernetic theory; the cyborg, for Clynes and Kline, is a 'self-regulating man machine system'.

The key component of the first section of the Manifesto is the observation of the breaching of boundaries by the cyborg, or the idea of the cyborg, that is the cybernetic organism, a fusing of the organic and the technological. As she later found out, thanks to a student, the first documented cyborg was a lab rat fitted with an osmotic pump, created by scientists interested in preparing the human body for space flight (Clynes and Kline 1995 [1960]; Haraway 1995). The space race is intertwined, of course, with the Cold War, with militarism and supremicism, making it, as Kunzru (1998: 6) says, 'a kind of scientific and military daydream'. But, Haraway argues, the cyborg is illegitimate, unfaithful, wily: it does not play by its father's rules, and can be put to different dreamwork. Thought differently, the cyborg can challenge the places from whence it came; this is part of its irony.

So part of the cyborg's challenge is that its existence – including its existence in science fiction as well as social reality – threatens fundamental boundaries that have long structured ways of understanding the world. These boundaries include those between:

- human and animal
- organism and machine
- physical and non-physical

Now, a big part of the irony is that science, or perhaps more accurately technoscience, has been at the heart of this undoing, this blurring and breaching of boundaries. To take some recent exemplars: xenotransplantation, the use of animal organs in human transplants, or sociobiology, which 'explains' human behaviour by looking at animals; smart machines (including smart weapons) that can 'think' for us and that are 'disturbingly lively' (Haraway 1991: 152); nanoscience and quantum theory, where material and immaterial are much closer together than we may have thought, where matter is energy – or, as Haraway poetically put it, where 'our best machines are made of sunshine' (ibid.: 153). In these and other ways, technoscience is troubling boundaries that have worked for so long to keep everything in its place.These tidy dualisms, integral to the Western worldview, have been ruptured as the modern technoscientific age has progressed (see also Latour 1993). For its role(s) in these 'transgressed boundaries, potent fusions and dangerous possibilities' (Haraway 1991: 154), the cyborg deserves our careful attention, our ironic handling.

But there's that bigger layer of irony to attend to: the cyborg is also implicated in 'the final imposition of a grid of control on the planet, [it is] about the final abstraction embodied in a Star Wars apocalypse waged in the name of defense, about the final appropriation of women's bodies in a masculinist orgy of war' (ibid.: 154). That's one way of reading the cyborg, but for Haraway that is fatalistic and fatal: better to at least try to build more livable worlds with this cyborg, better to think it and us differently:

> From another perspective, a cyborg world might be about lived social and bodily realities in which people are not afraid of their joint kinship with animals and machines, not afraid of permanently partial identities and contradictory standpoints. The political struggle is to see from both perspectives at once because each reveals both dominations and possibilities

> unimaginable from the other vantage point. … Cyborg unities are monstrous and illegitimate; in our present political circumstances, we could hardly hope for more potent myths for resistance and recoupling.
>
> (Haraway 1991: 154)

Absolutely not a technobunny's blissed-out ramblings, then: a Manifesto in the truest sense, a call to action, to change (see also Bartsch, DiPalma and Sells 2001).

FRACTURED IDENTITIES

In the second main section of the Manifesto, Haraway situates her work 'in relation to issues within feminist theory, including questions of identities in multi-ethnic communities where essentialisms don't seem to work, at a time when the category "woman" has lost its "innocence" as a political, analytic, and epistemological starting point' (Sofoulis 2002: 85). So this section concerns feminism in the 1980s, the splintering of feminist theory and politics into multiple feminisms – a fracturing too of the idea of a universal or essential category of 'woman' and of 'women's experience', destabilized by the vectors of difference (Weedon 1999). A time of heated debate within feminism, then, out of which Haraway hopes to salvage something, a new way of talking about identity, about feminism, about domination and resistance: 'What kind of politics could embrace partial, contradictory, permanently unclosed constructions of personal and collective selves and be faithful, effective – and, ironically, socialist feminist?', she tellingly asks (Haraway 1991: 157). Can feminism still being a meaningful politics, an identification, once difference is fully acknowledged?

In 'Fractured Identities', Haraway works through some ways of addressing this issue, starting with ways she finds unsatisfactory, critiquing both socialist and radical feminism, while wanting to hold on to something that each offers. She rejects attempts to totalize identity or experience, to claim to 'speak for' others under the common name 'Woman'. Yet she is also critical of the then-modish response to this, so-called difference feminism (or postmodern feminism), preferring instead to borrow some terms from another of her students, Chela Sandoval: oppositional or differential consciousness, and the methodology of the oppressed, used by Sandoval to talk about 'women of color' as a postmodern political identification that refuses unity (but also relativism; see Sandoval 1995). Like oppositional consciousness, then, Haraway calls for a cyborg feminism, a feminism built from 'partial [but] real connection' (Haraway 1991: 161) – a theme she develops in the next section of the Manifesto.

THE INFORMATICS OF DOMINATION

Here Haraway attempts to map out the world today, or at least a series of changes in ‘worldwide social relations tied to science and technology’ (Haraway 1991: 161); she produces a long chart of paired terms, comparing key terms from modernity to those of contemporary technoscience and arguing, in a way at once similar and different to Manuel Castells’ informationalism, for recognizing that we are now in ‘an emerging system of world order analogous in its novelty and scope to that created by industrial capitalism’; a world order built of ‘scary new networks’ – the informatics of domination.

Rather than repeat the whole list here – it has been reproduced by countless others – I will pick ‘n’ mix some pairs, and use them to illustrate the overarching lesson of the listing. First off, again echoing Castells and others, such as Jean Baudrillard, we have ‘representation’ replaced by ‘simulation’ – where the former maintains an anchor in the ‘real’ and the latter has come to stand in for reality. ‘Scientific management in home / factory’ is superseded by ‘global factory / electronic cottage’, ‘labor’ by ‘robotics’, ‘functional specialization’ with ‘modular construction’ – all similarly resonant echoes of the network society. And remember how Castells talked about the feminization of work, with the organization man replaced by the flexible woman? Haraway has a consonant pair here, too: ‘family / market / factory’ transposes to ‘women in the integrated circuit’ (see below). Lastly, at the foot of the table, we have the crunch: ‘white capitalist patriarchy’ becomes the ‘informatics of domination’.The new world order brings new dominations; the question will inevitably turn to new resistances before the Manifesto ends, the twinning of power and resistance revealing the influence of Michel Foucault on Haraway (Sofoulis 2002).

MICHEL FOUCAULT

Professor of the History of Systems of Thought at the College de France, Michel Foucault (1926 – 84) wrote widely and critically on social insitutions such as the prison and the mental asylum, and was concerned with how knowledge is used to produce order, to produce people as subjects, and to designate the ‘normal’ and the ‘deviant’ – to order subjects. He also developed theories of power / knowledge – the relationship between knowledge and power in modern societies, for example through surveillance; of the potentially ‘productive’ force of power, and of the role of discourse, or expert knowledges, in shaping societies in modernity. His work has been immensely influential across the humanities and social sciences.

The twin columns of the chart accomplish more than description, of course: the terms are unsettled or denaturalized by being paired, Haraway writes, the second term deconstructing (though she doesn't use that word) the first, undermining its authority as an original Truth. Or, as Jonathan Crewe (1997: 895) puts it, the chart performs an act of 'transcoding', with 'each term in the right-hand column transcoding and historically displacing its counterpart in the left-hand column'. Moreover, these new times, emblematized by the 'new' second terms, call for a new politics. For feminist theory and politics, this means attending to the informatics of domination: the actual situation of women is their integration / exploitation into a world system of production / reproduction and communication. This means addressing the new terms, not still kicking against the old ones. Hence one key route for 'reconstructing [note: *not* abandoning] socialist-feminist politics is through theory and practice addressed to the social relations of science and technology, including crucially the systems of myth and meanings structuring our imaginations' (Haraway 1991: 163). Communications sciences and biotechnologies turn the world into code – machine code, genetic code – producing 'fresh sources of power' that have to be met with 'fresh sources of analysis and political action', again showing her Foucauldianism. Understanding this is, for Haraway, crucial to the reconstruction of feminism in the times of the cyborg.

THE 'HOMEWORK ECONOMY' OUTSIDE 'THE HOME'

The new division of labour ushered in by the information age is the focus of this next short section – especially the new global working class, made up in large part of Castells' flexible women. Haraway borrows the term 'homework economy' to describe new work patterns, a 'world capitalist organizational structure … made possible by (not caused by) the new technologies' (Haraway 1991: 166) – underemployment, casualization, insecurity, lack of welfare, and a bi-modal social structure, switched on or switched off, valued or discarded. And not just work; private life, leisure time, intimacy are all restructured by science and technology. The question for Haraway then turns towards feminist science, towards the possibilities of doing science with an oppositional consciousness, of forging a new politics of science.

WOMEN IN THE INTEGRATED CIRCUIT

Here Haraway builds on the insights of the previous section to think through 'the complexities of international gendered and ethnic divisions of labor in the globalized economy' (Sofoulis 2002: 85), using the idea and ideology of the network as 'both a feminist practice and a multinational corporate strategy' (Haraway 1991: 170), akin to Castells' grassrooting the space of flows. In fact, in this section Haraway considers a sequence of idealized capitalist spaces – home, market, workplace, state, school, hospital, church – and then riffs the (ambivalent) impacts of science and technology on each, for example:

> *Home:* Women-headed households, serial monogamy, flight of men, old women alone, technology of domestic work, paid homework, re-emergence of home sweat-shops, home-based businesses and telecommuting, electronic cottage, urban homelessness, migration, module architecture, reinforced (simulated) nuclear family, intense domestic violence.
>
> *Church:* Electronic fundamentalist 'super-saver' preachers solemnizing the union of electronic capital and automated fetish goods; intensified importance of churches in resisting the militarized state; central struggle over women's meanings and authority in religion; continued relevance of spirituality, intertwined with sex and health, in political struggle.
>
> (Haraway 1991: 171 – 2)

Interestingly, in the 2004 reprint of this article in *The Haraway Reader*, much of this section, including these lists, has been cut by the author, perhaps a reflection of the even more ambivalent outcomes of twenty more years of the informatics of domination. Out of this discussion, she moves towards a position of hope, or at least grounds for hope, in a new partial feminist politics that rejects 'the feminist dream of a common language' (Haraway 1991: 173) and does not need to resolve contradictions and find universality.

CYBORGS: A MYTH OF POLITICAL IDENTITY

Hence a return to the cyborg, this time as it has been imagined in feminist science fiction, a source which Haraway finds inspiring for its abilities to think otherwise. Calling her chosen authors 'theorists for cyborgs' (Haraway 1991), she brings all the threads together, though together in the form of a cat's cradle – a favourite metaphor of hers – rather than anything tidied up and finished. As well as science fiction, she discusses writing by 'women of color' as producing other potent fusions and boundary transgressions, as a form of cyborg writing here conceived as being 'about the power to survive, not on the basis of original innocence, but on the basis of seizing the tools to mark the world that marked them as other' (ibid.: 175). Observing that 'writing is pre-eminently the technology of cyborgs' (ibid.: 176), and given her earlier comment about coding as the logic of the informatics of domination, she is thus able to conjure an affinity between feminist sci-fi cyborgs, in all their complex heterogeneity, and 'real-life cyborgs', such as 'the Southeast Asian village women workers in Japanese and US electronics firms' who are 'actively rewriting the texts of their bodies and societies'.

And she rehearses the key issue about dualisms as a way of knowing. We have used them in the West to order things, in a simple binary logic. Everything is either this, or not-this, with no room for in-betweens: 'self / other, mind / body, culture / nature, male / female, civilized / primitive' and so on (ibid.: 177). Western modernity has been all about this ordering and tidying up, and science has had a lead role to play in helping us collect, name and classify anything and everything (Latour 1993). The trouble is, technoscience has also led to the blurring of these binaries; as we find out more about the world, or come up with new marvels, so we undermine the simplicity of the binary classes. 'High-tech culture', Haraway says, 'challenges these dualisms in intriguing ways' (ibid.: 177). Cyborgs epitomize that intriguing trouble; they are irreducible back to one thing or another; instead of either / or, they are neither / both.

After tracking cyborgs in a selection of feminist science fiction texts, showing how they 'make very problematic the statuses of man or woman, human, artefact, member of a race, individual entity, or body' (ibid.: 178), Haraway moves towards her finale, with its famous, often-quoted phrases and ideas (I for one know this bit almost off by heart). First comes this intense set of statements:

> There are several consequences to taking seriously the imagery of cyborgs as other than our enemies. Our bodies, ourselves; bodies are maps of power and identity. Cyborgs are no exception. A cyborg body is not innocent; it was not born in a garden; it does not seek unitary identity and so generate antagonistic dualisms without end (or until the world ends); it takes irony for granted. One is too few, and two is only one possibility. Intense pleasure in skill, machine skill, ceases to be a sin, but an aspect of embodiment. The machine is not an *it* to be animated, worshipped, and dominated. The machine is us, our processes, an aspect of our embodiment. We can be responsible for machines; *they* do not dominate or threaten us. We are responsible for boundaries; we are they.
>
> (Haraway 1991: 180, emphasis in original)

Here is cyborg myth, cyborg gender, the cyborg reimagined away from militarism and the informatics of domination. 'We' *are* 'they': the categories blur and meld, 'the machine is us'. Sofoulis (2002) comments that this last segment of the Manifesto has often been misunderstood and misquoted in a decontextualized fashion, shorn of its socialist-feminist fuzz and buffed up to a shiny technophilia; certainly, as we shall see, the afterlives of Haraway's cyborg have taken it every which way, though this is in some senses inevitable – as Haraway (1995: xix) herself comments, 'cyborgs do not stay still'.

Here she is trying to story the world otherwise, to say that the cyborg is here, is us, but that we can do more than accept this on the terms of technoscience and the military – industrial complex. And returning finally to the question of feminism, as theory and politics, she comes to her famous summation. First, totalizing theory 'misses most of reality, probably always, but certainly now'. Second, it is inadequate to take up an anti-science and anti-technology standpoint – it is vital to find ways to work *with and against* science and technology, and here is where the cyborg can help us:

> Cyborg imagery can suggest a way out of the maze of dualisms in which we have explained our bodies and our tools to ourselves. This is a dream not of a common language, but of a powerful infidel heteroglossia. It is an imagination of a feminist speaking in tongues to strike fear into the circuits of the super-savers of the new right. It means both building and destroying machines, identities, categories, relationships, space stories. Though both are bound in the spiral dance, I would rather be a cyborg than a goddess.
>
> (Haraway 1991: 181)

Cyborg feminism – for some an uncomfortable, even oxymoronic term – is thus conjured here as a powerful force; powerful in its denial of dualisms, in its deployment rather than rejection of cyborg imagery, such as pleasure in machine skill, but still powerfully feminist. While this means rejecting the totalizing ideas of 'goddess feminism', it summons a resonant political alternative to challenge the informatics of domination. The rejection of previous articulations of feminism, goddess or radical or difference based, should not be misread as a rejection of feminism; far from it. This is not – or rather *not only* – the male cyborg of militarism or Hollywood. Indeed, in an interview Haraway insists that her cyborg is female:

> [The cyborg] is a polychromatic girl … the cyborg is a bad girl, she is really not a boy. Maybe she is not so much bad as she is a shape-changer, whose dislocations are never free. She is a girl who's trying not to become Woman, but remain responsible to women of many colors and positions, and who hasn't really figured out a politics that makes the necessary articulations with the boys who are your allies. It's undone work.
>
> (Penley and Ross 1991: 20)

So the irony is in taking the cyborg, whether a vivisected lab rat fitted for space flight, or the *tech-noir* fantasies of hypermasculine Terminators and Blade Runners, and turning them into something politically potent, feminist and progressive: 'cyborgs for earthly survival!' (Haraway 1995) As Schneider (2005: 66) sums up, 'Multiplicities. Heterodoxies. Monstrosities. Improbable but promising couplings made by choice and based on assumed short-term common ends as well as means. These are the marks of Haraway's cyborg as a figure to think and live with'.

GODDESS FEMINISM

Also known as thealogy, contemporary goddess feminism emerged alongside socalled 'second wave' feminism, in the 1970s, and it remains a thriving global movement with a number of variants. Often connected to ecofeminism, a branch of feminism stressing women's connection to the natural environment, and to the idea of the Earth goddess, it combines spiritualism, ecologism and feminism centred on the goddess as a symbol of life, natural energy and female essence. The goddess is seen as a healer of the broken bonds between human and nature, body, Earth and cosmos, and as a symbol of fecundity.

SUMMARY

The Cyborg Manifesto was written 'as a somewhat desperate effort in the early Reagan years to hold together impossible things that all seemed true and necessary simultaneously' (Haraway 2004a: 3), a response to a request to account for the fate and future of socialist feminism in this 'new world order'. Haraway summoned the cyborg as a boundary blurring trickster figure, working to undermine the dualisms which have hitherto structured how we think and live. Aware of the cyborg's implication in what she calls the informatics of domination, and equally mindful of the trap of totalization which had arguably dead-ended feminist theory and politics at the time, she draws on an unlikely grab-bag of resources in an attempt to think the cyborg otherwise, as a figure of irony but also of hope.

2 CYBORG INVOCATIONS

> Exuberant, expansive, perhaps over-responsible, and certainly ambitiously synthetic, with its own suggestive flaws and fissures, the chimerical assemblage of elements that is Haraway's Manifesto was capable of bearing many readings by highly divergent audiences.
>
> (Sofoulis 2002: 91)

Resisting the idea that she has somehow spawned a monster with a life of its